

Agentic AI Daily Digest — Wednesday, 24 June 2026

TL;DR

- **Five9** launched Voice AI Agents, directly challenging the agentic self-service market, but their seat-based pricing model remains a vulnerability for scaling AI deflection.
- **IBM** and Google Cloud announced a joint practice for deploying production AI agents, suggesting complexity in operationalizing IBM's platform.
- **Glean** was recognized in a Gartner Emerging Market Quadrant for "No-Code Agent Builders - Startup Vendors," reinforcing its internal/employee-facing focus rather than customer-facing CX.
- **Parloa**'s new study highlights consumer impatience with poor automation, creating an opportunity to contrast their lack of analyst validation with Kore.ai's proven platform.

Undercut Opportunities

Five9 — Launches Voice AI Agents for self-service — [Business Wire](#)

- **Lever:** Pricing/TCO (seat-based model exposed to AI deflection), Proof/validation gap (Forrester Strong Performer, not Leader, WFM scalability gap), Reliability/governance (AI bolt-on, governance new).
- **Angle:** Five9's new Voice AI Agents, while a step towards agentic self-service, are built on a fundamentally misaligned seat-based pricing model that penalizes customers as AI deflection increases. Their AI is a bolt-on, raising questions about deterministic behavior and battle-tested governance compared to Kore.ai's purpose-built agentic platform.
- **Kore.ai counter:** Kore.ai's ABL provides compile-time validation and deterministic execution for critical paths, ensuring auditable and reliable agent behavior. Our platform offers per-agent/intent/tool cost attribution, aligning cost with value as automation scales. We are a Leader in Forrester's Conversational AI for Customer Service Q2 2026.

Plays:

- **Sales:** "As AI containment rises, what happens to your committed seat spend with Five9? Can they model your cost-per-resolution two years out, accounting for AI overages?" "Forrester rated Five9 a Strong Performer with enterprise WFM scalability gaps – what production containment rates are they guaranteeing in regulated industries?"
- **PMM:** Create content comparing Five9's "bolt-on" AI agent approach and seat-based pricing vs. Kore.ai's native ABL platform and value-aligned cost model. Highlight Forrester's distinction between CCaaS Leaders and Conversational AI Leaders.
- **AR:** Brief analysts on Five9's continued reliance on a seat-based model for AI agents and the implications for TCO as deflection scales, contrasting with Kore.ai's value-based approach and ABL for governance.
- **Product:** Ensure Kore.ai's cost attribution and forecasting tools remain superior and easy for customers to understand.

IBM — Launches Joint Practice with Google Cloud for Production AI Agents — [theaisoftwarereport.com](#)

- **Lever:** Other (complexity/SI dependency), Proof/validation gap (slipped to Gartner Challenger).

- **Angle:** IBM's need for a *joint practice* with Google Cloud to *deploy production AI agents* suggests that even with watsonx Orchestrate, their platform's deployment and operationalization for complex enterprise scenarios might require significant external expertise and integration effort, contrasting with Kore.ai's more self-service, full-lifecycle platform. This also comes after IBM slipped to a Gartner Challenger in Conversational AI.
- **Kore.ai counter:** Kore.ai's ABL platform simplifies the entire agent lifecycle from build to deploy, with Git-native release engineering and compile-time validation, reducing the need for heavy SI dependency. We are a Gartner Conversational AI Leader, providing a clear, unified CX stack.

Plays:

- **Sales:** "Does IBM's 'joint practice' imply that deploying their production AI agents requires significant external consulting and integration beyond their platform? How does that impact your TCO and time-to-value compared to a self-service platform?" "Given IBM slipped to a Gartner Challenger, how confident are you in their unified CX roadmap?"
- **PMM:** Create content highlighting Kore.ai's ease of deployment and full-lifecycle platform capabilities, contrasting with the implied complexity of IBM's approach requiring a "joint practice" for deployment. Reinforce Kore.ai's Gartner Leader position.
- **AR:** Highlight the implications of IBM requiring a "joint practice" for deployment, suggesting platform complexity, and contrast this with Kore.ai's platform maturity and ease of operationalization.
- **Product:** Ensure our deployment tools and documentation are continuously streamlined to emphasize ease of use and reduced SI dependency.

Glean — Recognized as a Market Shaper in Gartner Emerging Market Quadrant — [Business Wire](#)

- **Lever:** Proof/validation gap (not a CX Leader), Channel/coverage gap (employee-facing, not customer-facing).
- **Angle:** While Glean is gaining recognition in *emerging* no-code agent builders for *startup vendors*, this reinforces that their focus and analyst validation remain in employee-facing knowledge management and search, not customer-facing conversational AI for CX, where Kore.ai is a recognized Leader.
- **Kore.ai counter:** Kore.ai is a Leader in Gartner Magic Quadrant for Conversational AI Platforms 2025 and Forrester Wave: Conversational AI Platforms for Customer Service, Q2 2026, specifically for customer-facing CX. Our platform is purpose-built for enterprise CX across all channels, not internal knowledge workers.

Plays:

- **Sales:** "Is Glean's solution designed for internal employee productivity or external customer-facing conversational AI? Which CX analyst evaluation names Glean a Leader for customer service?"
- **PMM:** Develop comparison content highlighting Glean's internal focus vs. Kore.ai's external CX leadership. Emphasize the difference between "Emerging Market Quadrant for No-Code Agent Builders - Startup Vendors" and "Magic Quadrant for Conversational AI Platforms" or "Forrester Wave: Conversational AI Platforms for Customer Service."
- **AR:** Proactively brief Gartner on the distinction between internal-facing knowledge management solutions (like Glean) and external-facing enterprise conversational AI platforms for CX (like Kore.ai).
- **Product:** N/A (Glean is not a direct CX competitor).

Parloa — Consumer Patience Index highlights automation risk and opportunity in CX — [TipRanks](#)

- **Lever:** Proof/validation gap (not evaluated by major CX analysts), Channel/coverage gap (limited geographic reach).
- **Angle:** Parloa's study rightly identifies the market need for better automated customer service, but without independent analyst validation as a Leader in the enterprise CX conversational AI space, and with limited geographic reach, their ability to deliver on this opportunity at scale for global enterprises remains unproven compared to Kore.ai.
- **Kore.ai counter:** Kore.ai is a Leader across six analyst evaluations, including Gartner and Forrester for Conversational AI in CX, with global enterprise deployments and 80+ connectors/250+ integrations.

Plays:

- **Sales:** "Parloa's study highlights a critical need. But which independent analysts have evaluated their platform as a Leader for enterprise CX, and how many verified enterprise references do they have outside their home region?"
- **PMM:** Use Parloa's study data to reinforce the market need, then pivot to Kore.ai's proven, analyst-validated capabilities for delivering superior automated CX globally.
- **AR:** N/A (Parloa is not yet on the radar of major analysts in a way that would require a specific brief beyond general positioning).
- **Product:** N/A.

Top Stories

Five9 Launches Voice AI Agents for Next-Gen Self-Service (2026-06-23) Five9 announced a breakthrough release of Voice AI Agents designed to power the next generation of agentic self-service, aiming to replace traditional IVRs. The new agents are touted for their ability to handle complex customer interactions autonomously. **Why it matters:** This is a direct competitive move by a CCaaS incumbent into the core agentic AI space, aiming to address critical customer pain points like IVR frustration. While it signals market validation for agentic self-service, Five9's underlying seat-based pricing model and bolt-on AI approach present an opening for Kore.ai to highlight its superior TCO and native platform governance.

[Business Wire](#)

IBM and Google Cloud Form Joint Practice for Production AI Agent Deployment (2026-06-22) IBM and Google Cloud have launched a joint practice focused on deploying production AI agents for enterprises. This collaboration aims to help customers operationalize agentic AI solutions, leveraging both companies' expertise. **Why it matters:** This partnership suggests that deploying complex AI agents in production environments, even with platforms like IBM watsonx Orchestrate, can require significant external support and integration. For Kore.ai, this highlights the value of a comprehensive, self-service platform with ABL that simplifies the entire agent lifecycle from build to deploy, reducing reliance on extensive consulting engagements. theaisoftwarereport.com

Parloa's Consumer Patience Index Reveals High Stakes for Automated CX (2026-06-22) A new study by Parloa, the "Consumer Patience Index," indicates that poor automated customer service leads many consumers to switch brands, with 1 in 3 Americans preferring to switch brands rather than be put on hold. The study highlights both the risk and opportunity in CX automation. **Why it matters:** This research underscores the urgent market demand for effective, high-quality automated CX. While Parloa is drawing attention to this need, their own platform lacks the independent analyst validation and global enterprise reach of Kore.ai, creating an opportunity to position Kore.ai as the proven solution for addressing these critical customer experience challenges at scale. [TipRanks](#)

Competitor Watch

Cresta (2026-06-24) Cresta is showcasing its AI Customer Experience capabilities at CCW Las Vegas. This event presence indicates continued focus on their core market of contact center AI, including agent assist and AI agents. **Why it matters:** Cresta continues to actively market its CX AI solutions, leveraging industry events. Kore.ai should continue to emphasize its platform's superior governance and full-lifecycle capabilities, especially against Cresta's prompt-plus-custom-code approach. [TipRanks](#)

Five9 (2026-06-24) simplywall.st published an analysis questioning if Five9's new Voice AI Agent Studio is reframing its long-term moat in contact centers. This follows multiple announcements (2026-06-23) about Five9 launching Voice AI Agents to replace IVR and enhance customer experience. **Why it matters:** The market is scrutinizing Five9's strategic shift to AI agents, particularly regarding its long-term competitive advantage. This reinforces the need for Kore.ai to highlight its differentiated, AI-native platform approach and predictable TCO model. [simplywall.st](#)

Glean (2026-06-24) Glean and TinyFish have partnered to enable AI agents to act on live web data within secure enterprise contexts, bridging the gap to the live web for enterprise AI agents. **Why it matters:** Glean continues to enhance its enterprise AI agent capabilities, focusing on data access and real-time information for internal knowledge workers. This reinforces their horizontal, employee-facing positioning, distinct from Kore.ai's customer-facing CX focus. [BriefGlance](#)

Sierra (2026-06-23) Cybernews published a review explaining Sierra's enterprise CX agent platform. **Why it matters:** A detailed review of Sierra's platform provides insights into their capabilities and positioning. Kore.ai should monitor such reviews for any specific claims or gaps that can be leveraged against Sierra's strong brand and funding, particularly concerning independent CX analyst validation and determinism for regulated industries. [Cybernews](#)

Parloa (2026-06-23) Chain Store Age reported on Parloa's survey findings, indicating that poor automated customer service drives consumers to switch brands. This echoes Parloa's broader "Consumer Patience Index" findings (2026-06-22). **Why it matters:** Parloa is actively positioning itself around the need for improved automated CX. While this validates the market, their lack of major analyst recognition and narrower geographic focus remain exploitable weaknesses for Kore.ai. [Chain Store Age](#)

Genesys (2026-06-22) Nectar announced an expansion of its Genesys Cloud Observability with new Operational Intelligence Capabilities. **Why it matters:** This partnership enhances Genesys Cloud's monitoring and management capabilities, which is positive for their ecosystem. It doesn't directly create an undercut opportunity but shows Genesys is continuing to build out its platform through partners. [Morningstar](#)

Platform & Big-Tech Moves

Salesforce Agentforce

- (2026-06-23) Salesforce is expanding its Formula 1 push as VCARB deploys Agentforce for AI-powered fan engagement. [CX Today](#)
- (2026-06-23) Petty Products went live on Rootstock ERP and Salesforce Agentforce Revenue Management to drive business agility. [Business Wire](#)
- (2026-06-23) simplywall.st published an analysis suggesting Salesforce (CRM) stock could be 54.5% below fair value on Agentforce growth hopes. [simplywall.st](#)

ServiceNow Agent Platform

- (2026-06-23) Cognizant integrated ServiceNow (NOW) AI Agents with its Neuro AI Multi-Agent Accelerator. [Yahoo Finance](#)
- (2026-06-23) Nametag deepened its partnership with ServiceNow to protect enterprise helpdesks against impersonation attacks. [Business Wire](#)
- (2026-06-23) The Globe and Mail explored whether strategic partnerships can help ServiceNow scale enterprise AI adoption. [The Globe and Mail](#)

IBM Agent Platform

- (2026-06-23) IBM published an article titled "Stop optimizing chatbots: Why customer care needs agentic orchestration," advocating for a shift to agentic approaches in customer care. [IBM](#)

Analysts & Rankings

- (2026-06-22) Glean was recognized as a Market Shaper in the 2026 Gartner® Emerging Market Quadrant for No-Code Agent Builders - Startup Vendors. [Business Wire](#)

Funding, M&A & Industry

Nothing material in the window.

Quick Hits

- (2026-06-22) Cybernews published a review titled "Kore.ai Review – Is It Worth the Price?" [Cybernews](#)